



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 44

TEXAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Texas's family courts and child-welfare system.

137

TEXAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 183
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 27, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
41 OF 254

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

TEXAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 137 Texas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 183 130 of 137 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$20,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 18 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 48.2% 31.4% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 137	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.4	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 130 of 137	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 41

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Texas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF TEXAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	85	\$20,000	\$98,110	\$8,339,390
Lost Wages	68	\$10,000	\$72,610	\$4,937,472
Other Court Fees	52	\$550	\$11,115	\$577,989
Therapy / Evaluations	67	\$1,000	\$5,273	\$353,290
Reunification Services	47	\$0	\$1,282	\$60,252
GAL Fees	58	\$300	\$5,071	\$294,100
Asset Loss ¹	65	\$30,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$61,850	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost		30	2.5 yrs
Total across all families		2,428	202.3 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · TEXAS

Most families documenting in Texas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Not provided		47	34%
Active case: stuck or delayed		45	33%
Case closed: within last 2 years		23	17%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		11	8%
I am currently in an active case (progress is being made)		3	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		46	34%
Family Court Only		45	33%
Unknown		26	19%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		13	9%
Foster Care / Termination of Parental Rights (TPR)		2	1%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		27	20%
5 – 10 years		21	15%
3 – 5 years		16	12%
6 months – 1 year		16	12%
5+ years		14	10%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		36	26%
50/50 Joint		32	23%
Visitation Only		32	23%
Full Custody		11	8%
Partial / Shared		11	8%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Tarrant		11	8%
Harris		8	6%
Denton		4	3%
Lubbock		3	2%
United States		3	2%
Williamson		3	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		36	26%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		15	11%
Other: (Short answer)		14	10%
High Conflict Divorce		12	9%
Family Court		11	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — TEXAS

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



My case is an anomaly. It started out with CPS illegally taking my kids because I couldn't find my prescription medication that they knew my OBGYN prescribed me. 10 hrs after they took my babies I found my medicine bottle but they didn't care. My kids were put in foster care but [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Caused the worst pain ever imaginable it's like the children are ripped out of our lives and we don't know if their dead or alive but definitely abused and should be allowed to be taken to a place of their mother's choosing to have their forensic interview's denied by their [...]

— TEXAS PARENT · DANA

MORE VOICES FROM TEXAS

The family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. They're alienated for me. My oldest hates me and thinks the grandmother told them that I abandoned them. The family court system in Wilbar County Texas has abused my children. Their alienated for me. My [...]

— SHAWN

Family court fraudulent took my kids and placed them with the parent that they were initially removed from with CPS.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has destroyed me and my kids bond my family my peace of mind in my right to be a mom to my children

— ELNETTA

The family court system has caused even more trauma for my son and I, and places our abusers rights, over my child's safety. Over 6 years they have exhausted my family me, and my son, and all of our time, effort, and finances, while my son continues to be abused by his father [...]

— GRACE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



I lost any joy in my life at all. Everything a mother should be there for was ripped away. I have 2 sons that were married with children when this happened with my daughter so when they took her. I had nothing anymore. All over false accusations and a caseworker named Chrystal [...]

— TERRI

Stolen my only child. Facilitated and assisted the abuser in continued abuse and neglect to myself and my child.

— HEATHER

The judge didn't listen to my children when he took them to his chambers and they told him the physical abuse they witnessed at the hand of their father he didn't listen to the things the kids had went through being mentally abused by him. He did not listen to the answers where [...]

— MIRANDA

They battered our family and used illegal covert systems to damage and exploit nakedness images of adults and children fir their satisfied leverage

— BRANDI

Tortured us, stolen my children's youth and our family

— CRYSTAL

This system has destroyed my life, rendered me homeless, cost me well over \$20k and counting, and has crushed my son's heart and soul. I am still in the fight. I will try to hold out as long as possible. The family court system and my ex's attorney are evil incarnate and need to [...]

— JACOB

I have watched the Texas system ignore documented abuse, silence my daughters voices, and use its power not to protect vulnerable children, but to shield the very structures that failed them.

— STEPHANIE

Destroyed a mother-son relationship, empowered and protected parental alienation, caused trauma in mother and son, ignored facts and evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm so thankful that the courts got it right for my children and me.

— RACHEL

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Absolutely destroyed my motherhood and their childhood.

— LESLIE

Ignored a psych evaluation that said he's a danger to children and should never be alone with them. Caused Stockholm's syndrome in my children, deep trauma and alienation from my family and me.

— BOBBI

The system has made my children fatherless and destroyed our financial stability.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex file a TRO taking my kids from me immediately. I was scared and traumatized and ended up, settling with him having primary. My children's lives have been completely flipped up upside down, and he continues to do harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Demolished my family. It took my kids from a loving mother and gave them to a monster.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were taken away from me unannounced, based solely on the word of my abuser & his wealthy parents which traumatized one of my 3 children severely. I have spent over 6-1/2 years defending myself & children from constant litigation, everything from an intervention filed [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stolen my child from me and his grandparents and siblings.

— LAUREN

It destroyed it. My children's lives and hearts are destroyed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has ruined me i barely know how to live anymore. It has allowed for my children to be used for profit in their pockets and I have to sit there and watch them be abused. I am lost soul

— DAKOTA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This system has caused such a distress my children will never get familiar time back from those that have passed.

— KRISTIN

The system has not protected my children from an abusive parent who also disclosed to a coparenting facilitator that he has been engaging in alienating parent activities like trying to win over the kids and talking bad about me and my spouse to the kids. Judge was only concerned [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped a newborn away from us causing loss of precious bonding time

— SARAH

This system has traumatized my family and dehumanized us to the core. We are missing our child so dearly

— SHIAERA

Torn family apart and caused more trauma

— TIFFANY

The Masons tried to murder me and slandered my name to try and steal my children.

— SARAH

The legal/court system has completely and utterly let down a parent that 150% should have the children. When a registered sex offender gets primary custody of a child, something is seriously wrong.

— MONIQUE

Removing kids for 9 days and for kids to be involved in domestic violence again being theater and hurt

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This process has left me feeling silenced and overwhelmed, forcing me to fight alone for my child's stability while our lives have been disrupted by delays, false accusations, and a lack of fairness in being heard.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Punished my children and me for no crime committed at a cost of time that can't be calculated

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed me as a loving caring dedicated mother and survivor of marital abuse. Losing children as a mother is the new scarlet letter. We are never left the same, the emotional and psychological damage is insurmountable and society is very unforgiving towards us. The [...]

— CLAUDIA

Traumatized, bankrupted, lost opportunities, childhood, etc

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have caused a tremendous amount of set backs for me an my family financial, emotional , mental ect . Where is our pursuit of happiness

— TIFFANY

Just when I thought I could get my life back, I met a man as sick as my ex-husband and the entire system has taken everything I own, and separated me from everyone I hold dear! They're still coming after me because I won't remain silent until I get my retirement back and my kids [...]

— THERESA (STORMY)

Trying to take my rights and have my 3 boys adopted

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took 7 months of normal time with my baby, due to false allegations that led to supervised visits and inability to keep breastfeeding. My 2 week old infant was handed to the father in court even though he's not listed on birth certificate. I lost child support I'd been getting [...]

— KATELYN

85 Texas parents submitted ranked quotes. 40 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/tx.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Texas report comes from Texas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Texas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 137 Texas families reporting here are not the universe of Texas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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